

M. Cecilia Ramírez-Michelena

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

mcramirezmichelena@gmail.com | John M. Keynes 1–11, Office 1601, Barcelona, Spain

Research Profile

My research examines how educational choices, institutions, and public policies shape inequality over the life cycle, with a particular focus on gender gaps in STEM, school-to-work transitions, and labor market outcomes. I use administrative and survey data, randomized field experiments, and quasi-experimental methods to conduct policy-relevant research in labor economics, education economics, gender inequality, and applied microeconometrics.

Affiliations: Department of Economics, Universitat de Barcelona; Institut d’Economia de Barcelona (IEB).

Education

Universitat de Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain

Ph.D. in Economics

Expected 09/2026

Dissertation: *Essays on Gender Inequality, Educational Choices, and Labor Market Pathways*.

Supervisors: Profs. Lúdia Farré and Andreu Arenas.

University of Washington, Seattle, United States

M.Ed. in Educational Foundations, Leadership, and Policy Studies.

2021

Specialization in *Organizational and Policy Studies*.

M.A. in Economics

2021

Universidad de Montevideo, Montevideo, Uruguay

M.A. in Economics

2020

B.A. in Economics

2016

B.A. in Management and Business Administration

2016

Academic Appointments

Institut d’Economia de Barcelona, Universitat de Barcelona

01/2023 – Present

Predoctoral Researcher and Instructor

Barcelona, Spain

- Conduct doctoral research in education and labor economics using administrative and survey data; apply difference-in-differences, event-study, and regression discontinuity designs, and decomposition methods to generate evidence on gender inequality, educational choices, and labor-market trajectories.
- Design and implement a discrete choice experiment and randomized information intervention for middle-school students in Catalonia. Coordinate survey design, intervention materials, and school recruitment under the Women and Science Program (Paris Dauphine–PSL University).

Education Policy Analytics Lab, University of Washington

09/2018 – 09/2019

Predoctoral Researcher

Seattle, United States

- Conducted applied research in partnership with Seattle Public Schools on teacher effectiveness, absenteeism, recruitment, and retention in schools serving low-income students.
- Analyzed administrative education data to document staffing patterns and inform district evaluation strategies and policy responses.
- Collaborated with district leadership, analysts, union representatives, and program managers to align empirical analysis with institutional priorities and communicate results to academic and non-academic audiences.

Center for Research in Applied Economics, Universidad de Montevideo

06/2015 – 07/2018

Research Assistant

Montevideo, Uruguay

- Contributed to the design and implementation of randomized controlled trials evaluating labor inclusion and social protection interventions targeting vulnerable populations.
- Developed field protocols, coordinated data collection, and contributed to quantitative analysis and academic and policy outputs.

Publications and Working Papers

- Abilities and Career Choices: Addressing the Gender Gap in STEM Fields. With A. Arenas and L. Farré. Working Paper. Presented at BRIDGE Economics of Education Workshop (KU Leuven) and SEHO Annual Meeting, 2025.
- Educational Gains from School Electrification in Rural Areas. With M. Blanco and N. D’Agosti. Working Paper. Presented at European Association of Labour Economists (EALE), 2024.
- Strategies to Increase the Take-up of Social Benefits: Evidence from a Field Experiment. With A. Cid, J.M. Cabrera, and M. Blanco. Working Paper.
- Tablets for Deeply Disadvantaged Older Adults: Challenges in Long-term Care Facilities. With A. Cid, R. Sotelo, and M. Leguisamo. *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies* (2020).

Grants & Fellowships

Fellowships

Dr. Joan Guinovart Fellowship, Societat Econòmica Barcelonesa d’Amics del País	2026
Doctoral Fellowship, Fundación Ramón Areces	2023 – 2026
Doctoral Fellowship, Generalitat de Catalunya	2023
Graduate Fellowship, University of Washington	2018 – 2020
Fulbright Scholarship for Graduate Studies, Fulbright Commission	2018 – 2020
Research Scholarship, Universidad de Montevideo	2016 – 2018

Research Grants

Women and Science Program, Paris Dauphine-PSL University – EUR 10,000	2024
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Teaching Experience & Student Supervision

Universitat de Barcelona, B.A. Thesis Advisor, Department of Economics	2026 – Present
Universitat de Barcelona, Instructor, Department of Economics	Spring 2024, 2025
University of Washington, Instructor, Department of Spanish and Portuguese Studies	Fall 2020 – Spring 2021
Universidad de Montevideo, Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics	Fall 2014 – Spring 2015

Research and Technical Skills

Statistical Software: Stata, R. **Other:** LaTeX, Git/GitHub, Claude Code, LLM-assisted coding.
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), Catalan (B1; B2 expected June 2026), French (basic).